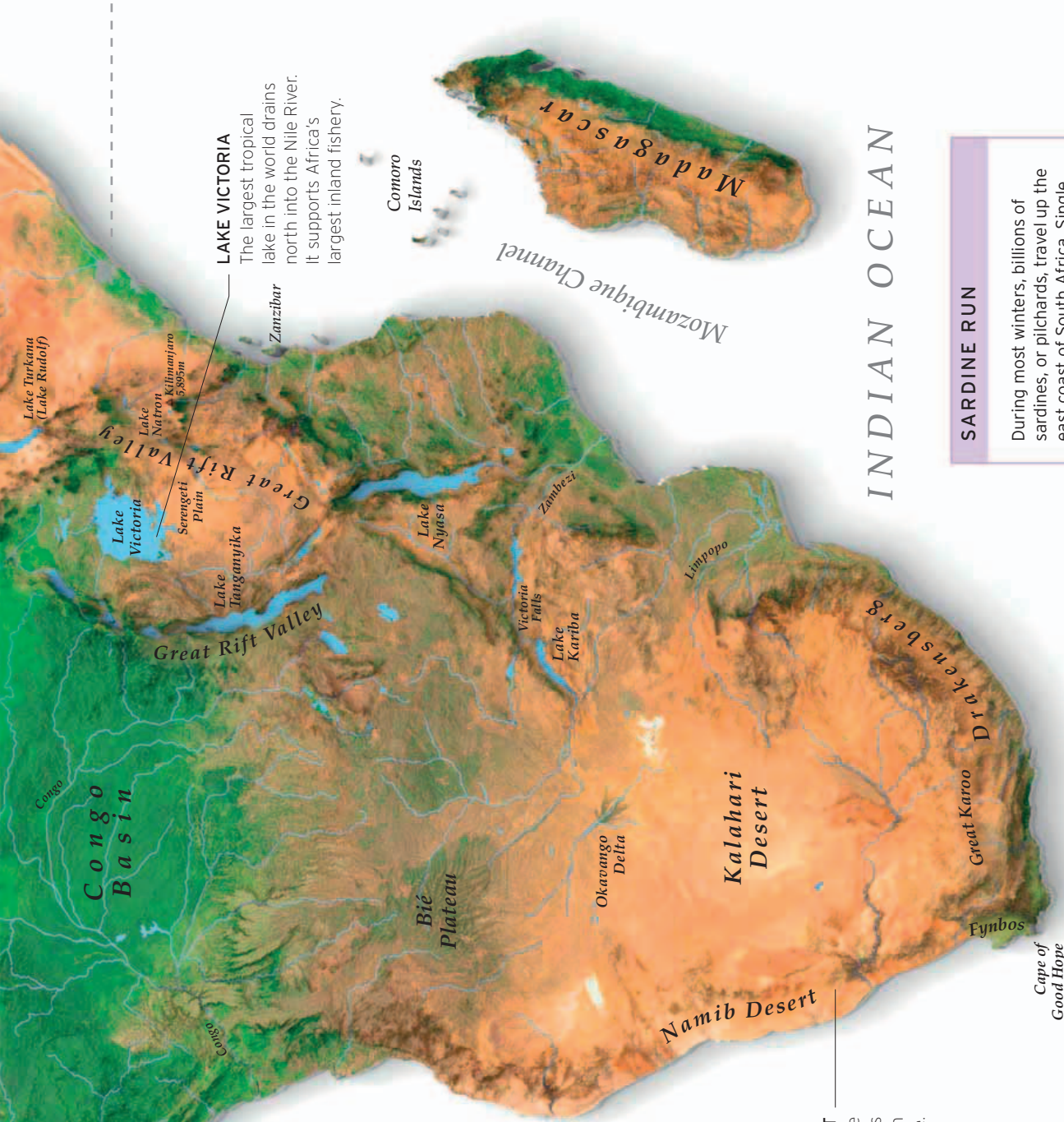




Gulf of Guinea

Bioko

EQUATOR

São Tomé

ATLANTIC OCEAN

SAHEL

The semi-arid grasslands of the Sahel mark a transition between the desert and the savannas and forests further south. Enough rain falls during the wet season to allow this ecosystem to support great biodiversity and provide a stopping point for migrating birds.



COMMON REDSTART

NAMIB DESERT

Rainfall is so infrequent in the Namib that some specialist plants and animals rely solely on frequent sea fogs for moisture.

LAKE VICTORIA

The largest tropical lake in the world drains north into the Nile River. It supports Africa's largest inland fishery.

Comoro Islands

Mozambique Channel

Madagascar

INDIAN OCEAN

SARDINE RUN

During most winters, billions of sardines, or pilchards, travel up the east coast of South Africa. Single schools stretch for miles, and are the target of spectacular feeding frenzies attracting predators such as sharks, dolphins, and birds.



FYNBOS



This band of coastal and upland heath, flourishing in the Mediterranean climate of the Western Cape of South Africa, is a central component of the Cape Floristic Region. This tiny ecoregion is unmatched in biodiversity and endemic plants per square mile. Of 9,000 plant species known in the area, a staggering 6,200 occur nowhere else.

FEATURED ECOREGIONS



- Ethiopian Highlands » p178-83**
Montane grassland, woodland
- Great Rift Valley Lakes » p184-91**
Freshwater lakes, soda lakes
- Serengeti Savannas » p192-207**
Tropical grassland
- Congo Basin » p208-17**
Tropical, subtropical moist broadleaf forests
- Okavango Delta » p218-27**
Wetland: inland river delta
- Kalahari Desert » p228-35**
Desert, scrub
- Madagascan Dry Forest » p236-43**
Tropical dry broadleaf forest